

Apple device or some other brand, you will get support for high-quality audio.

In terms of the app, Nothing Ear (2) is miles ahead of Apple. If you read through my review of Nothing Ear (2), you'd have realised that I loved every bit of the app. There are a few kinks which Nothing can iron out, but they have made an app which other brands can take inspiration from. On Apple's side, there's no dedicated app on the iPhone. There's a dedicated section in the settings menu where you can play around with the settings.

Being a rational consumer, you will expect that Apple would have made an app for Android users as well. However, they have not. If you are connecting your AirPods to an Android device, you are stuck with the default settings. And things like Spatial Audio and Ear-tip fit tests are concepts that do not even exist on that side of the wall.

The on-ear detection on the Nothing Ear (2) was on point regardless of the platform I was using them with. On Apple's side, it worked seamlessly with Apple devices. However, once I switched over to an Android device, there were hitches in the play pause, and I could often notice an abnormal lag. At this point, as I mentioned in the review as well, Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) uphold their tag of being the ultimate Apple TWS earbuds. Apple being the keyword here.

Lastly, let me talk about connectivity. The connectivity between the AirPods and Apple devices is unmatched. But, as soon as you move to devices that do not sport the half-eaten fruit logo, you are faced with unnecessary issues. Nothing Ear (2) on the other hand, on both the Apple and non-Apple side of things, handle multi-point connectivity much better than the AirPods. And, if you are sticking to an Android device, most of the time, their fast-pair works as well as that of the AirPods on Apple devices.

Winner - Nothing Ear (2)

Performance

In terms of the sound signature, if you look at the graphs, you will see that the AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) beat the

FEATURES		
VOICE ASSISTANT	8	9
WATERPROOF RATING	5	4
CONTROLS	8.5	9
CHARGING	9	7
EXTRA CODECS	10	5
DEDICATED APP	9	6
ON EAR DETECTION	8	9
WIRELESS CHARGING	1	1
OVERALL	6.5	5.6

PERFORMANCE		
MICROPHONE	7	8.8
EARBUDS (SOUND SIGNATURE)	8	8.5
OVERALL LISTENING EXPERIENCE	8.5	7
BATTERY LIFE	5.6	6.3
CHARGING CONSISTENCY	9	7
ANC EFFICACY	8	9
OVERALL	7.7	7.8

Nothing Ear (2) outright. They have a more balanced sound than the Nothing Ear (2), which the purists would prefer. On the Nothing Ear (2), we get a boost in the bass frequencies. That is balanced out by the boost in the highs.

If you are a purist, then you will prefer the sound of the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation). If you are a bass lover, then you will love the sound profile of Nothing Ear (2). Once you factor in the price, though, things get a bit more balanced. The Nothing comes pretty close to the

AirPods. Only if the bass boost was not as prominent, then they could have even beat the AirPods Pro in terms of the sound signature scores.

When it comes to battery life, the AirPods had the Nothing Ear (2) beat very easily. In our tests, we found the battery life of the Appel AirPods (2nd Generation) at 50 per cent volume and ANC turned on, to be 5 hours. On the other hand, the Nothing Ear (2), with the same settings, clocked in 4.5 hours of battery life. This gave the AirPods a